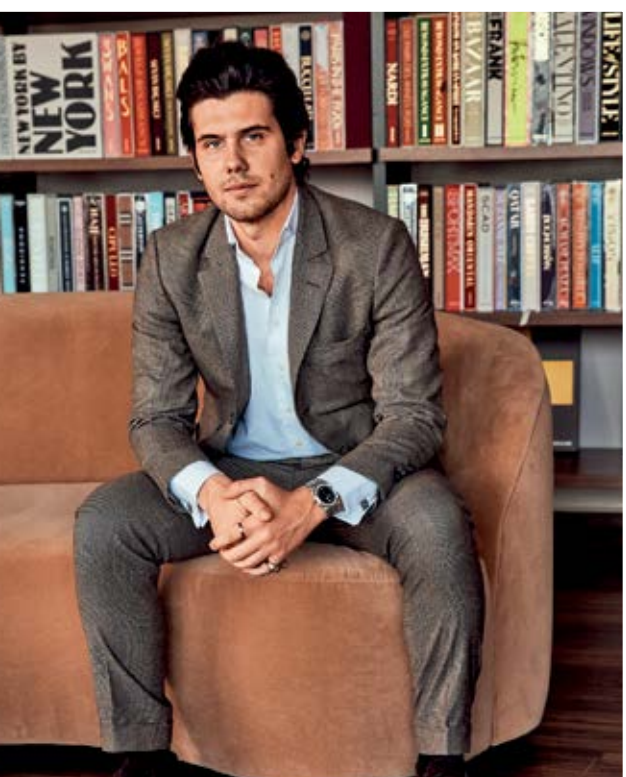
Ultimate Page-Turner

At a time when digital screens dominate, Assouline's Indian debut explains why physical, handcrafted books are the next big frontier in luxury gifting and décor

By RIDHI KALE

Known globally for turning coffee table books into high-fashion statements, Assouline has officially made its Indian debut with a compact yet highly effective flagship boutique at The Chanakya, Delhi. In an era ruled by endless scrolling, opening a brick-and-mortar bookstore might seem like a gamble. But when the brand in question is Assouline, the iconic luxury publishing house, the rules of traditional retail simply do not apply. With a soaring demand from India's elite, an Assouline book might just replace your next luxury watch as the ultimate statement gift.





Standalone Strategy

Bringing Assouline to India was a direct response to an underserved, design-conscious clientele that previously had to source these visual volumes from international markets. While other luxury labels often test the waters with small concessions or shop-in-shops, the luxury publishing house insisted on a dedicated, standalone home to fully showcase its identity. "India has always inspired us. It has an extraordinary heritage of craftsmanship, and storytelling and today it is one of the most dynamic markets in the world. There is a growing community of connoisseurs here who travel, collect and see books as objects to live with," shares Alexandre Assouline, president, Assouline. "We wanted to offer a place to discover the Assouline world in person and New Delhi, with its depth of culture and history, was the natural place to begin," he adds.